INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Marketing

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Discuss actions employees can take to achieve the company's desired results.
2. Describe marketing functions and related activities.
    3. Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).
    4. Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships.
5. Demonstrate suggestion selling.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the sales floor supervisor at GREEN THUMB GARDEN CENTER, a family-owned garden center that sells plants, flowers, soil, tools and outdoor decor. The general manager (judge) wants you to plan how to train the store's seasonal employees so spring sales grow and more customers come back.

GREEN THUMB makes 45% of its yearly sales between April and June. Every spring, it hires about 25 seasonal employees, mostly high school students, and gives them a one-hour orientation. Last spring, the average customer spent $38, and most bought only plants. Customers who skip the right soil and fertilizer often see their plants die, blame the store and never return. GREEN THUMB's online reviews praise its plant selection but say employees "don't know much about gardening." A home improvement store opened five miles away last year with lower prices on many of the same plants.

The general manager (judge) wants you to:

- Explain how seasonal employees can help GREEN THUMB reach its spring sales goals
- Recommend what seasonal employees should be trained to do on the sales floor, including suggesting additional items
- Explain how better customer service can keep customers coming back to GREEN THUMB instead of the home improvement store

You will present your ideas to the general manager (judge) in a role-play to take place in the general manager's (judge's) office. The general manager (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the general manager's (judge's) questions, the general manager (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do we suggest more items without customers feeling pushed?
2. Our employees are teenagers who may not garden. How do we get them ready in a short time?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Discuss actions employees can take to achieve the company's desired results.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Describe marketing functions and related activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.).	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Demonstrate suggestion selling.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	